few of them left on the earth and soon they might extinct. It is reported that nearly 132 species of plants and animals are critically endangered in India. Snow leopard, Bengal tiger, Asiatic lion, Purple frog and Indian giant squirrel are some of the endangered animals in India.

DO YOU KNOW?

Each year, 22nd May is celebrated as World Biodiversity Day. Biodiversity is a term used to describe the different plants, animals, marine life, microorganisms, insects, habitats, ecosystem etc. that make our planet so unique and so fascinating.

Many algae, fungi, bryophytes, ferns and gymnosperms are disappearing with the destruction of forests. And, each disappearing species may take away with it many species of animals and microbes which depend on them for food and shelter. Similarly, list of animals on the verge of being lost is endless. Prawns, oysters, lobsters, crabs, squid, octopus, cuttlefish, beetles, dragonfly, grasshoppers, fish and even frogs are dying by absorbing poisonous gases through their skin. Locust is one insect which has almost disappeared from India. Following animals are getting rare these days.

- Reptiles: Some lizards, turtles, crocodiles and gharials.
- Birds: Falcon, eagle, hawk, vulture, peacock-peahen, pigeon, duck.
- Mammals: Wild cats such as tigers, lions, deer such as chinkara and blackbuck, chiru (Tibetan goat), musk deer, rhino, elephants, blue whale, flying squirrel.

Table 22.3 Endangered plants and animals.

Endangered Plants	Endangered Animal
Umbrella tree	Snow Leopard
Malabar lily	Asiatic Lion
Rafflesia flower	Lion tailed macaque
Indian mallo	Indian Rhinoceros
Musli plant	Nilgiri Tahr

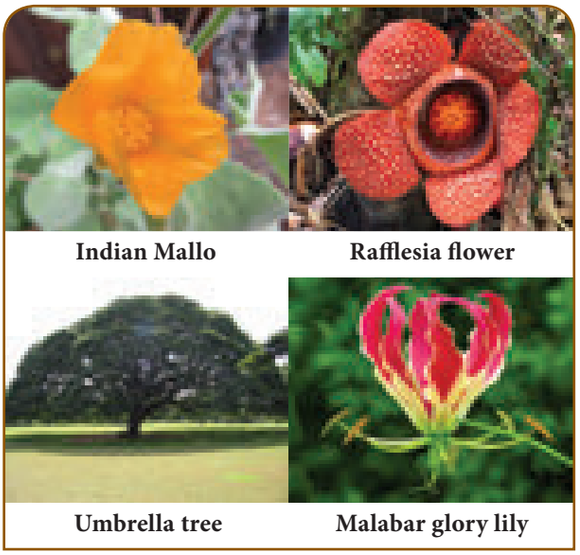


Figure 22.7 Endangered plants

Activity 5

Collect as many pictures of wild plants and wild animals as possible. Prepare a poster showing the endangered species separately.

22.4.1 Determination of Endangerment

Whether a particular species is endangered or not is determined by the following ways.

- When the geographical range of the species is limited.
- The population of the species is limited i.e., less than 50 adult individuals.
- When the population has decreased or will decrease by more than 80% in 10 years.
- If the population is less than 250 individuals and is continuously declining at 25% for the past three years.
- There is a high possibility of extinction in the wild.

DO YOU KNOW?

Yeoman Butterfly has been declared state butterfly of Tamil Nadu. This species is endemic to Western Ghats. It is among 32 butterfly species found in Western Ghats.



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